

DISCIPLESHIP 101

LESSON 1

REPENT

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 4:17 *“From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.”*

Applying This Command

Repentance is more than just a one-time event that happens at salvation. A pattern of repentance in a believer's life is key to obeying the Word of God and reflecting the character of God.

Choosing to follow this command involves a daily commitment to address the way we think.

Why is this significant? Our thoughts determine our actions. Our actions do not primarily come from a whim of our will or our feelings. Instead, our actions are a byproduct of what we have been choosing to think about.

If we leave our thoughts unchecked, our lives will take on the character and attributes of whatever influences our lives.

As believers, genuine change happens in our lives when we fully submit our minds to thinking the thoughts of God. This takes

place as we daily exchange our thoughts for His thoughts,
meditating on His Word.

We should meditate in focused, set apart times, and we should meditate throughout the day. The more we soak ourselves in the living Word of God, the more our lives will reflect His life and character.

Bible Verses

Matthew 4:17

Revelation 3:19

Psalms 51:1–4

Acts 3:19

Acts 8:22

Proverbs 1:23

II Corinthians 5:10

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LESSON 2

ASK SEEK KNOCK

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 7:7–8 *“Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you: For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.”*

Applying This Command

Do you ever wonder how to pray? Or do you feel like God delays in answering your prayers? The command of Christ *Ask, Seek, and Knock* is brimming full of promises that God will answer prayer! It gives hope, encouraging us to not give up, and provides practical steps on how to pray as believers.

It is easy to fall into the trap of becoming self-centered when we pray. This can even cause our prayers to become ineffective. In Luke 11, Jesus highlights an even greater purpose for prayer...the needs of others! Focusing on the needs of others not only takes our eyes off ourselves; it also gives us the opportunity for God to use us in the lives of others.

God longs to show Himself strong by answering prayer when we pray in agreement with His Word. Whether it is for a personal

need or for someone else's, it is our privilege and responsibility to pray.

Our Heavenly Father, God delights to supply the needs of His children as we become more dependent upon Him in prayer.

Bible Verses

Matthew 7:7–8

Matthew 7:9–11

James 4:3–4

John 14:14

Psalm 81:10

Psalm 34:10

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LESSON 3

FOLLOW ME

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

John 4:19 “*And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.*”

Applying This Command

The command to Follow Me is not an idea or a suggestion. Rather, it is an imperative call that must be followed by choice.

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his choice must be made by every person, and it will determine the course of his or her life.

While the words of Jesus in Matthew 4:19 are a command, they are also an invitation to live the abundant life of Jesus.

Christ’s life should fill every area of our lives, as we fully surrender to His Lordship and follow Him wholeheartedly.

In this command, Jesus was calling His disciples to exchange their identity as fishers of fish, to become fishers of men.

When we choose to follow Christ, He replaces our old identity with a new identity in Him. As we live in the reality of this new

identity, He empowers us to live the Christian life by His Spirit dwelling in us.

The key to living a fulfilled life in the Lord, and walking as fishers of men, is first being filled with His Life. As a result, Christ's Life within us, blesses and ministers to those around us.

The more Christ increases in our lives, the more we can invest in the lives of others for eternity, walking as fishers of men.

How Can We Follow Jesus Now That He Is in Heaven?

When the disciples followed Jesus, they were with Him 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, for 3 years. They learned how He thought, how He answered questions, how He lived, and how He gave Himself for people.

Jesus is now in Heaven; however, He made provisions for us to continue to be with Him 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, for the rest of our lives. First of all; He is within every believer, as the Scripture states: "Christ in you, the hope of glory" (Colossians 1:27).

He also sent His Holy Spirit to live within us, and to guide us in His ways. (See John 14:16–18.) Just as the disciples walked with the Lord and did only those things that the Lord directed, so we are to walk in the guidance and power of the Holy Spirit.

The result of this fellowship is that the Lord can accomplish more through our lives than He accomplished in His earthly ministry. *“Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father”* (John 14:12). The more time we spend with Christ by meditating on His Word, the more we will be able to reflect the light of His truth to others.

Bible Verses

Matthew 4:19

Psalms 63:8

Matthew 19:28–29

II Corinthians 4:1–4

Proverbs 11:30

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LESSON 4

ABIDE

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

John 15:4-5 *“Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abide in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me. I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.”*

Applying This Command

The command of Christ *Abide in Me* emphasizes the very heart that God is trying to communicate through every command, He has ever given: a personal relationship with Jesus.

It is not enough for a believer to just know about Christ and what He has done for us. If we desire to grow in our relationship with the Lord, Christ must become the very source of our life, and the power to fulfill each command.

The more we learn to totally depend upon Christ as our life, the more He will accomplish His will in and through us! This is the secret to living the Christian life: Christ living and operating as Lord in the life of the believer!

Without the life of Jesus within us, and the power and ability which comes from that life, the commands of Christ are impossible to do.

It is as believers fully yield control of the right to live and operate their own life the way they want to, that Christ, through the power of His Holy Spirit, can begin to take complete control and perform His will in them.

The Christian life isn't about trying harder; it is about recognizing our total inability, and embracing Christ's ability, through the power of His Spirit!

Bible Verses

I Corinthians 1:30

Exodus 20:1–6

John 15:3

Psalm 119:9

II Corinthians 10:5

John 15:7

Psalm 1:1–3

Matthew 6:21

John 14:21–23

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LESSON 5

COME UNTO ME

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 11:28-30 *“Come unto me, all ye that labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls. For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.”*

Applying This Command

When two animals are yoked together, one of them must be dominant and the other one submissive. If two strong-willed oxen are yoked together, there will be constant tension as one ox pulls one way with a faster pace, and the other tries to pull another way at a slower pace.

Jesus calls all those to come to Him who *“labour and are heavy laden”* (Matthew 11:28). In this command, Jesus states that He will give weary one’s rest before He tells them to put on His yoke and learn of Him.

There is good reason for this sequence. We cannot be yoked to Jesus if we are already yoked to the bondage of sin.

All those who repent of sin and cry out to God for His mercy and forgiveness will be delivered from the burden of sin.

Romans 10:9–13

Bible Verses

Philippians 2:5–7

I Peter 2:21

I John 2:6

Psalm 25:9

I Peter 3:4

Psalm 55:22

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LESSON 6

FEAR NOT

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 10:28 *“Fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.”*

Applying This Command

Hundreds of times in Scripture we are instructed not to fear and not to be afraid.

At the same time, we are told to fear the Lord. The same Hebrew and Greek words are used to describe both the fear that we should not have toward man, and the fear that we must have of the Lord.

The primary Hebrew word used for *fear* is yaré. It means “*to revere, to frighten, to make afraid, and be dreadful.*”

The Greek word for *fear* is phobeo which means “*to be alarmed, to be frightened, to be in awe of, and to revere.*”

Fear is extremely important because we bow down to what we fear. If we fear man, we will bow down to man and be intimidated by him. If we fear our children, we will bow down to them, and they will control us.

But if we fear God, we will worship Him and give Him His proper honor and reverence.

When David faced Goliath he had no fear, because he realized that Goliath was not defying him or even Israel, but the name of the Lord. He was, therefore, confident that God would protect His own life and reputation by allowing him to conquer Goliath.

He had previously built his faith by conquering a lion and a bear.

In contrast to this, David was fearful when his own son Absalom who rose up against him. He fled for his life, because he knew that Absalom's wrath was against him personally, and that this was part of the judgment of God for his sin with Bathsheba.

Jesus did not fear people, because He understood their thoughts and motives. He did not fear Satan, because He knew He could overcome anything thrown in His path. Jesus did not fear death, because He had already purposed to give His life for the salvation of all who believe on Him.

Bible Verses

Proverbs 29:25

I John 4:18

Hebrews 2:14–15

Matthew 10:22

Romans 8:31

Revelation 2:10

Psalm 118:6

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LESSON 7

HEAR GOD'S VOICE

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 11:15 *“He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.”*

Applying This Command

As we study the command to Hear God's Voice, we must ask the question: what are we currently listening to?

Whatever we focus in on, we end up following.

The more time we take to spend with God filling our mind with His Word, the greater ability we will have to hear His voice.

Sometimes, we feel God is not speaking to us. But often this assumption is not true. The fact is that He is speaking but we are not able to hear, because we have not positioned ourselves to hear from Him. (This is the purpose of fasting)

If we are not careful, the noise of the world will drown out the voice of the Lord.

May the Lord help us to be persistent in making time each day to hear the voice of the Lord.

Bible Verses for Meditation

John 10:27

Matthew 4:4

John 16:13

Psalm 16:7

Romans 10:17

I Corinthians 2:11

John 14:23–24

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LESSON 8

BE RECONCILED

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 5:23-24 *“Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath aught against thee; Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift.”*

Applying This Command

When we offend someone, naturally our first response is to justify ourselves rather than seeking reconciliation. If we are at fault or not, this type of attitude is focused on one thing: self. At its root, this selfish focus is fueled by a spirit of pride. It is our pride that not only prevents us from experiencing unity with the one whom we have offended, it also hinders us in our relationship with God.

Pride is self-confident, self-focused and self-saturated. There is no room to focus on anyone else or their needs. But, when we consider the command **Be Reconciled**, we find that we need each other.

We don't just need each other, we cannot accomplish God's will without one another.

This is why the command **Be Reconciled** is so important.

As believers in Jesus Christ, God's Word says that we are members **"one of another"** in the Body of Christ (Romans 12:5).

Our actions not only affect us; they impact those around us—especially those closest to us. It is only as we humble ourselves and seek to make past offenses right that we will maintain close fellowship with God and fulfill His purposes, operating as one in the Body of Christ.

Bible Verses

Ephesians 4:26

I Corinthians 12:25–27

Acts 24:16

Romans 12:17–18

Proverbs 21:14

Proverbs 17:14

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LESSON 9

LET YOUR LIGHT SHINE

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 5:16 *“Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.”*

Applying This Command

A critical component of light is energy. If there was nothing energizing the light, there would be no light.

The command of Christ, *“Let Your Light Shine”* is exactly the same. Christ says that we as believers are the “light of the world.”

Without Christ being the very source of our life, we will not have the ability to shine His light. This is why being diligent to take time developing a personal relationship with the Lord is so vital.

God not only becomes the very source of our life, He also displays His life through us. It is this life that shines His light for others to see, drawing them to Himself.

The opposite is also true. Trying to imitate God's light without Him as the very source of that light, is actually a counterfeit effort.

This is a facade and will not stand the test of time. It is only by abiding in the light, that we are able to reflect light into our world.

Bible Verses for Meditation

John 8:12

Ephesians 5:8

Ephesians 2:10

Philippians 2:14–15

I Peter 2:12

Titus 3:8

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LESSON 10

SEEK THE KINGDOM

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 6:24-33 *“No man can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon. Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life ... But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.”*

Applying This Command

Have you ever stopped to consider the question, “What is God’s Kingdom and how does it relate to me?” That is a big question!

At its root, it is quite simple: God’s Kingdom is where He reigns as King! At a first glance, this answer may seem insignificant. But it sheds incredible light on the command Jesus gave in Matthew 6:33, to seek God’s Kingdom.

The life of a believer is not to be one lived in fear and anxiety about having their basic needs met. Why? Our Heavenly Father, Who is the King of kings, is more than able to provide for the citizens of His Kingdom.

It is for this reason that our primary responsibility is to seek the King's will in all we do. This is the secret to a successful Kingdom life!

When a Kingdom operates in this manner, not only does the Kingdom prosper, but so do the individual lives of each citizen.

So it is in God's Kingdom. As believers, we are no longer bound to serving the fears and worries of this world. Why? Because we have been set free from it by the finished work of our King, Jesus.

In Him, we have a completely new life, citizenship, and values! If we desire to experience the fullness of this new citizenship, we must seek God as our King in every area of our life. As we do, He has promised to supply our every need!

Bible Verses

John 3:3

Luke 18:29–30

Matthew 5:6

John 6:27

Philippians 3:7–8

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LESSON 11

MAKE DISCIPLES

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 28:19-20 *“Go ye therefore, and teach all nations . . . teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you always, even unto the end of the world. Amen.”*

Applying This Command

By definition, a disciple is a “disciplined learner.” The Greek word most frequently translated disciple is “mathetes”. It means “a learner.” The root word (*manthano*) indicates thought accompanied by action.

The learner is one who not only accepts the teaching, but also makes it a rule of conduct.

The word translated disciple is in contrast to the word translated “master”, “*didaskalos*”, which means “a teacher”.

Jesus said in Luke 6:40 ***“The disciple is not above his master [didaskalos]: but every one that is perfect shall be as his master”.***

A believer becomes a disciple when he learns to observe all the commandments of Christ. This is the message that Jesus gave to His disciples when He gave them the Great Commission. (Read Matthew 28:19-20 again)

Each of us are called to go out and tell our story to those who are searching for the peace that only Christ can bring. We do not need to have a lot of Biblical knowledge to share our story, we just tell about how He has redeemed us, and let the world know that they also can have this peace.

We are commanded by Jesus to be disciples, making disciples.

Bible Verses

II Timothy 2:2

I Corinthians 11:1

Luke 14:26–27, 33

John 13:35

Acts 14:22

Colossians 1:28–29

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LESSON 12

RECEIVE GODS POWER

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Luke 24:49 *“And, behold, I send the promise of my Father upon you: but tarry ye in the city of Jerusalem, until ye be endued with power from on high.”*

Applying This Command

The Spirit of God is called the Holy Spirit, and since He now lives in us, He wants to have a holy dwelling place. Literally, through the indwelling of the Holy Spirit, Heaven is setting up a base station within each of us.

When we receive the Holy Spirit, we are instantly infused with extra power to live an overcoming life. Acts 1:8 *“You shall receive power after the Holy Spirit comes upon you, and you shall be witnesses for me in Jerusalem, all of Judea, Samaria, and untlo the uttermost parts of the earth.”*

When we receive the infilling of the Holy Spirit, we become the base station through which God can display His power in the earth. (Signs, Miracles and Wonders)

Who qualifies to receive this power? All born again believers.

Bible Verses

Acts 1:8

John 20:21–22

Romans 8:15–16

II Timothy 1:7

Galatians 5:22–23, 25

Luke 11:13

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LESSON 13

WATCH AND PRAY

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 26:41 *“Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”*

Applying This Command

The Greek word that Jesus used in this command is “gregoreuo”. It means “*to keep awake, i.e. watch.*”

It denotes giving careful attention and mindfulness in the face of danger; keeping from drowsiness, with conscious earnestness and alertness; denouncing all slackening in the energy of faith and conduct.

It can be used in a physical, moral, or spiritual sense.

The Hebrew word “shamar” adds to the richness of this spiritual exercise. It means “*to hedge about as with thorns, to protect, to attend to.*” We are being told here to express the careful

attention, which was paid to the obligations of a covenant, to laws or to statutes.

Watching and praying, then, is an interaction with the Holy Spirit. He knows the mind of God and He can reveal the dangers that we, or those under our care, will face.

When we are watchful and prayerful, we are much less likely to succumb to temptation.

Bible Verses

James 5:16

Ephesians 6:11–12

Romans 8:26

I Corinthians 16:13–14

Matthew 6:13

I Corinthians 10:13

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LESSON 14

BE BAPTIZED

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

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Applying This Command

Baptism is not a means of conversion, but a means of identification with the Lord Jesus Christ. Water baptism is a pattern of:

- Going into the water as our old sinful self
- Burying our sins and old life in a watery grave
- Rising to walk in newness of life

Water baptism is a public declaration of faith in Christ. It is our way of saying we are following the Lord in death to self.

Each person who is baptized should realize that when he goes under the water, his own life comes to an end. When we come up from the water, we are now to consider ourselves dead to self and alive to God.

Jesus set the example of water baptism and has commanded each of us to follow Him in this way. If Jesus needed water baptism, how can we refuse to be baptized? Luke 3:21-22

Bible Verses

Matthew 28:19.

Acts 2:38

Acts 8:36–37

Ephesians 4:4–6
–16

Mark 16:15

I Peter 3:21

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LESSON 15

KEEP MY COMMANDMENTS

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

John 14:15 *“If ye love me, keep my commandments.”*

Applying This Command

This same word is used to describe the care that the Philippian jailer was to exercise, to keep Paul and Silas safe, and to make sure that they did not escape. When the jailer thought that they had escaped, he took out his sword to kill himself. (See Acts 16:16–34.

During the times of wind-driven ships, navigators would use the phrase “keeping the stars.” This meant that they would use the stars to chart a course across the ocean.

This is precisely how the commands of Christ are to be used: to chart a course throughout life, so that we please Him. The distinction between “keeping” and “doing” the commands is seen in passages such as this one: *“Ye shall keep my statutes, and do them . . .”* (Leviticus 20:8).

The very best way to keep the commands of Jesus Christ before is to memorize them, and meditate on them until they are engrafted in our souls. When they become a living part of the mind, will, and emotions, we will have achieved the goal of John 15:7: *“If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.”*

Joshua was commanded to meditate on God’s Law *“day and night,”* that he might have good success (see Joshua 1:8).

The psalmist affirmed that the person who is truly blessed of God is the one who meditates on His Law, day and night: *“His delight is in the law of the LORD; and in his law doth he meditate day and night. And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper”* (Psalm 1:2–3).

The commands of Christ should become first nature to us.

Bible Verses

John 14:21

Deuteronomy 6:6–7

Joshua 1:8

John 15:10–11

I John 2:3–5

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LESSON 16

BE BORN AGAIN

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

John 3:5-7 *“Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God. That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit. Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye must be born again.”*

Applying This Command

Jesus describes our salvation as being born again. Nicodemus questioned how one could be born again as an adult. Jesus explained that we must be born of water and of the spirit to be able to inherit the Kingdom of God:

- Water – The natural birth
- Spirit – The spiritual birth

A marvelous transformation occurs in the life of a person who is born again. Paul explains the change in this way, *“If any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.”* (II Corinthians 5:17).

The word “*become*” is in the perfect indicative tense, which indicates that the action has already been completed in the past but has continuing results in the future. This emphasizes two aspects of our salvation. The first is our position in Christ. The second is our experience as we grow in Christ.

A new believer takes on the righteousness of Christ and is righteous in Him. However, he is to exercise the energy of the Holy Spirit in carrying out righteous deeds. We are holy in our position before God, but we are also instructed to “*perfect holiness in the fear of the Lord.*” (See I Peter 1:16 and II Corinthians 7:1.)

When God’s life flows into us through the new birth, there will be several clear indications that something wonderful has taken place. For some people, the evidence of new birth will be immediate and dramatic; with others, they may develop more slowly.

- We become less like the world and more like Jesus.
- We desire spiritual things over temporal things.
- We love like Jesus and stop hating on others.
- We have a desire to be with the people of God.
- We desire to be disciplined in the things of God.

Peter exhorted believers, “*As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby.*” (I Peter 2:2).

One of the works of the Holy Spirit is that of conviction both pre-conversion and post-conversion.

Bible Verses

John 3:5–6

Ephesians 4:22–24

John 1:12–13

I Peter 1:23

I Peter 2:2

John 14:1

Romans 10:9

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LESSON 17

EAT AND DRINK

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 26:26-28 *“As they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed it, and broke it, and gave it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body. And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it; for this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.”*

Applying This Command

It was at the communion table that Jesus revealed Himself as the sacrificial Lamb. There is no other sacrifice.

It was also at this table that Jesus revealed the true nature of His disciples: one would betray Him, all would forsake Him. One, Peter, would deny Him three times, before the night was over.

Jesus ate the Passover with His disciples before He was crucified. The act of breaking bread is an intimate time where much can be brought to light. Such was the case in this Passover meal.

Jesus set the example for us to come together around the communion table, and Paul reminded the Corinthians, and us, to continue this discipline.

Paul admonishes us to examine ourselves when we come to the communion table. The communion table should be viewed as regularly planned stops, where we take the time to remember what Jesus did for us, and to have a time of solitary introspection.

Paul also tells us to continue doing this on a regular basis, “*until He comes.*”

Bible Verses

Psalm 139:23–24

I Corinthians 11:28–30

II Corinthians 13:5

Galatians 6:3–4

Psalm 26:2

Lamentations 3:40

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LESSON 18

AWAIT HIS RETURN

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 24:42-44 *“Watch therefore: for ye know not what hour your Lord doth come. But know this, that if the goodman of the house had known in what watch the thief would come, he would have watched, and would not have suffered his house to be broken up. Therefore be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.”*

Applying This Command

This command does not instruct us to know when Christ will return, but rather to be ready for His return, at any moment.

All the debate and division among believers over the timing of Christ’s Second Coming detracts attention from the great truths that we are to learn from this coming event.

This command makes it clear that no one knows the precise timing of His return. The Scripture makes it clear that not only does man not know when Jesus will return, but that the angels nor Christ know either. If the angels and Jesus do not know the

timing of the Second Coming, one can be assured that we do not know.

The point is, that we should be living as if He is coming today! When we live as if His coming could occur at any time, it causes us to keep all matters right with God and man.

If we believe His return is imminent, we should be working to reach each of our friends and family. The fact that Christ could return at any moment should motivate us to make the very best use of every minute that we have.

There is much to do for the Lord, and we can labor only until the time He returns. At that point, we must give an account of how we used all the time and resources that He entrusted to us.

Based on the shortness of time and the evil in the world, Paul wrote, ***“See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil. Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.”*** (Ephesians 5:15–17).

Paul repeats this instruction in Colossians 4:5, ***“Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time.”*** To redeem a coupon is to use it and stop it from going to waste.

In light of His Second Coming, what are we doing to redeem the time and resources He has placed in our hands?

Bible Verses

I Peter 4:7

John 14:2

James 5:7–8

I Thessalonians 5:4–6

I John 3:2–3

DISCIPLESHIP 101

LESSON 19

LOVE THE LORD WITH ALL YOUR HEART

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 22:37-38 “Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind. This is the first and great commandment.”

Applying This Command

Jesus identified this command as the first and greatest one of all. Nothing will ever be more important to God than for us to love Him with all our hearts. Nothing should ever be more important to us, than showing our love for God.

Jesus follows the first and greatest commandment by saying, the second commandment is to “*Love your neighbor as ourselves.*” He then states, “*On these two commandments hang all the Law and the prophets.*”

This is big - every other command or teaching in the Bible is simply an application of these two commands. All other Scriptures must therefore be interpreted on the basis of how they teach us to love God and one another.

First of all; loving God means that we must respond to His marvelous grace by devoting all our affections, our thoughts, our wills, and our strength to Him. It means that we dedicate our bodies to Him, and purpose to lay down our lives for Him, and the advancement of His kingdom.

It means that we detect and renounce every competing affection, such as loving money, loving the world, or loving our own lives, because we know that to love these things more than we love God, is to make us, and them an enemy of God.

Bible Verses for Meditation

Exodus 34:14

John 14:15

John 14:21

I John 5:3

Matthew 10:37

Deuteronomy 10:12–13

I John 4:19

Proverbs 8:17

DISCIPLESHIP 101

LESSON 20

LOVE THY NEIGHBOR

WHERE IS THIS COMMAND FOUND?

Matthew 22:39-40 *“Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind” And the second [commandment] is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbor as thyself. On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.”*

Applying This Command

In this passage of scripture, a lawyer asked Jesus to name the most important commandment, Jesus stated, *“Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind”* (Matthew 22:37). The previous Scripture stands to reason – right? Of course!

However, Jesus didn't stop there, He continues by saying, "... ***the second commandment is like unto it...***" The Greek word translated for "***like unto it***" is "*homoios*", which means "resembling, such as, the same as."

Jesus' statement is a very significant statement, because it means that when we love our neighbor, we are actually proving that we love God.

"Thou shalt love thy neighbor as thyself." There is solid Biblical support for this concept because we are all made in the image of God. Therefore, if we despise or curse a fellow man, we are also despising and cursing God.

James also makes this connection when he writes about the tongue. James 3:9 ***"Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, which are made after the similitude of God."***

In Matthew 25:40 Jesus said, ***"Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me"***

God created every person in the world, and one day everyone will stand before God's throne to be judged. However, God loves all humans so much that He sent His only begotten Son to die for our sins, so that they would be spared His judgment.

If God loves every human being so much that He was willing to give His only begotten son for us, how then should we treat one another?

Bible Verses

Romans 13:8

Philippians 2:3

James 2:8–9

I John 3:17

I John 4:20–21

Galatians 5:13–14